

# CRIMES OF THE HEART

*by Beth Henley*

*Directed by David Buchman*



This production is  
dedicated to Dom  
Grasso

**Jan 17-  
Feb 2**

**Sponsored by  
Ned & Paula Skinner**



# FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR



*CRIMES OF THE HEART* can be betrayal, abandonment, or heartbreak. Which can lead to affairs, lies, and attempted murder! All on a quiet little street in Mississippi.

*Life is NOT a fairytale and isn't heading in that direction any time soon in the small town of Hazlehurst. In classic dark comedy fashion, we see what a person, or in this case three sisters, do to console their breaking hearts. And then how does it work out when they might be facing jail time?*

*We tell this story because we have all probably faced something in our own lives that you simply could not even make it up if you tried. It can lead to hopelessness and despair and in many cases, an inescapable feeling of doom. But whenever there is the slightest glimmer of hope, we can help each other face the future with an opportunity to keep wishing for something better and different. Once again, a message for these times. Innocence may be lost, but there is a message that must never leave us...we must hope enough to carry on for, if nothing else, a better day!*

-Sherrie Provence, Executive Director of the Limelight Theatre

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# Director's Note



*The old proverb states: "If wishes were horses, beggars would ride." CRIMES OF THE HEART starts with a wish interrupted and for the next two hours, we experience how the wishes (mostly unfulfilled) of our six characters shape the people they are. Do we take control of our destiny or do we allow fate and other people's opinions shape our abilities to achieve our dreams...or is wishing on a birthday cake's candles enough? The obstacles that life throws at us, such as hurricanes, abusive spouses, and relatives' opinions, can leave us crippled, both physically and emotionally. Yet, CRIMES OF THE HEART focuses on getting through those bad days and ends with another wish, this time simply for kinder and gentler times. Never more is this a significant wish.*

*One of my wishes is for Dom Grasso to be here to see this amazing set that he designed. Sadly, we lost Dom soon after we went into rehearsal for this production. This was my third opportunity to direct a play on one of Dom's set designs; I think it is, perhaps, his best design ever. This entire production is dedicated to his memory.*

*I would like to give a special thanks to Chad Boyd, Don Cupo, Lois Dent, Lucy Farrow, Rob O'Leary, Chris Poland, Ryan Provence, Sherrie Provence, Lilah Racaniello, Ned & Paula Skinner, Day Stanchi, Linda Takita and Michael Takita.*

**DAVID** directed *Independence*, *Oleana*, and *August: Osage County* at the Limelight Theatre, *Art* (also performing as Serge) for A Classic Theatre, and *Jury: The Musical*, *Ashes 2 Ashes*, *A Person's Proof*, and *Vanities* for Take A Chance Theatre. Previous roles include Constable Joe (*Tuck Everlasting*), Ethan (*Storefront Church*), Captain Lesgate (*Dial M For Murder*), Ralphie's father (*A Christmas Story*), Nunzio (*Over The River and Through The Woods*), and Felix (*The Odd Couple*). Additionally, David appeared in the short films *Garden Therapy* and *Raging Ravioli*, both written and directed by Donald Patrick Cupo. Dr. B. (as David is called by his students) is a professor of Hospitality and Tourism Management at Florida State College at Jacksonville. He is honored and proud to serve as the Secretary for the Limelight Theatre's Board of Directors.

# Cast

LENNY MAGRATH.....JESSICA RACANIELLO  
MEG MAGRATH.....MARY ELIZABETH SCHUBERT  
BABE BOTRELLE.....ELIZA KISS  
DOC PORTER.....KYLE GEARY  
CHICK BOYLE.....KATIE TIMONEY  
BARNETTE LOYD.....CHAD BOYD



# Crew

Director.....David Buchman  
Stage Manager.....Day Stanchi  
Assistant Stage Manager.....Victoria Caro-Crespo  
Set Design.....Dom Grasso  
Costume Design.....Linda Takita  
Lighting Design.....Michael Takita  
Board Operator.....Ashley Taylor  
Technical Director.....Ryan Provence  
Props.....Lois Dent  
Paint Charge.....Sue Schwartz  
Scenic Paint.....Lourdes Acosta  
Construction.....Tom Ferry, Rob O'Leary,  
Ryan Provence, Charles Ross  
Production Manager.....Ryan Provence  
Photographer.....Ryan Provence  
Trailer.....Charity Walton

## Special Thanks:

Chad Boyd, Don Cupo, Lois Dent, Lucy Farrow, Rob O'Leary, Chris Poland, Ryan Provence, Sherrie Provence, Lilah Racaniello, Ned & Paula Skinner, Day Stanchi, Linda Takita and Michael Takita

# Cast & Crew

## Chad Boyd



Chad Boyd (Barnette Lloyd) is incredibly grateful to share the stage once again in his SEVENTH show here at Limelight! Past productions at Limelight Theatre include *The Last Five Years* (Jamie Wellerstein), *Bright Star* (Billy Cane), *First Date* (Man #1), *Over The River And Through The Woods* (Nick Cristano), *Big Fish* (Will Bloom), and *Parade* (Frankie Epps). He is a fellow graduate of the Florida School of the Arts, earning his Associates Degree in Musical Theatre. Chad would like to thank his friends, family and the community for their continued guidance, love and support! To follow his future endeavors, make sure to follow him @chad\_\_boyd on Instagram!

## Kyle Ceary



Kyle (Doc Porter) is a lifelong actor and musician native to Atlantic Beach, Florida. This is his second performance as Doc Porter in *Crimes of the Heart*, the first performance being in his junior year of high school 13 years ago. This is also the second time Kyle has taken the stage at the Limelight, previously portraying Stephen Biddle in *The Kitchen Witches* last season. Kyle has also been seen in many plays and musicals at All Beaches Experimental Theatre, Players by the Sea, and most recently stage managed The 5 & Dime Theatre Co.'s production of *Lizzie: The Musical*. Favorite roles include Darryl in *Bright Star*, Isaac in *HIR*, and

Francis in *La Cage Aux Folles*. When not on stage, Kyle enjoys being outdoors, volunteering with Scouting America, journaling, and catching up with his therapist.

## Eliza Kiss



Eliza Kiss (Babe Botrelle) is thrilled to be making her Limelight debut in *Crimes of the Heart*! Originally from Winter Park, Florida, she was most recently seen as Claire in *Rumors* (Players by the Sea). Some of her favorite on-stage roles include Countess Andrenyi in *Murder on the Orient Express*, Actress One in *Baskerville*, and Elinor in *Sense & Sensibility* (Grandstreet Theatre), Goneril in *King Lear* (Montana Shakespeare Company), Desdemona in *Othello* and Princess Katherine in *Henry V* (Porters of Hellsgate in Los Angeles), and Melody in Bekah Brunstetter's *Be a Good Little Widow* (NoHo Arts Center in Los

Angeles.) She also acted as Assistant Director for *Julius Caesar* with the University of North Florida's Shakespeare in the Park and has served as an acting and vocal coach. She holds a Bachelor of Fine Arts in Acting from Florida State University. Outside of the theatre, Eliza has worked on numerous films, television shows, and commercials. She also produces/narrates audiobooks on Audible and teaches at Beaches Music Together, an early childhood music education program in Ponte Vedra Beach and Nocatee. She is incredibly grateful to her family and friends for their continued love and support!

# Cast & Crew

## Jessica Racaniello



Jessica (Lenny Magrath) has been involved in community and regional theatre for many years in Connecticut, New York and Florida. She is thrilled to be back at Limelight Theatre. Recent theatre highlights include her portrayal of Sara Whitmore in *Church & State* at A Classic Theatre in St. Augustine, and Margot Wendice in *Dial M for Murder* at the Limelight Theatre. Other memorable roles include Sandra in *A Thousand Clowns* at Westport Community Theatre, Bella in *Lost in Yonkers* at the Crystal Theater, Jean in *POTUS* at the 5 & Dime and

Rosetta Wakeman in *Rosetta* at the New City Summer Festival in NYC. Her recent screen work includes roles in *I Saw Mommy Dissing Santa Claus* (2024), *The Scars of Time* (2024) and *Bumbling Ballerina* (2023). Thank you to her wonderful husband and inspiring daughter for always encouraging her to perform.

## Mary Elizabeth Schubert



Mary (Meg Magrath) is so happy to be back at the Limelight Theatre with another wonderful story to share. Since moving from Maryland, she has found another home on stages across Jacksonville and St. Augustine, beginning with *An Enemy of the People* right here. Favorite credits include Casey in *First Date*, Lily Whitfield in *Alabama Story*, Carol in *Oleanna*, Florence Unger in *The Odd Couple*, Shelby Eatenton in *Steel Magnolias*, Denise in *The Harvest*, and Kay Banks in *Father of the Bride*.

## Katie Timoney



Katie (Chick Boyle) is very excited to revisit the works of Beth Henley after appearing as Popeye Jackson in Limelight Theatre's 2014 production of *The Miss Firecracker Contest*.

More recent Limelight performances include: *Bright Star* (Florence/Spirit), A staged reading of *A Doll's House* (Nora Helmer), and *Bus Stop* (Elma). Area credits include: *POTUS* (Stephanie) 5&Dime, *No Exit* (Inez) A Classic Theatre, and most recently *Maddie* with Rising Tide productions where she originated the role of Maiden. She would like to thank everyone for their love and support. To see more of her adventures follow her on Instagram: @Violetwicche.



# Cast & Crew



## Victoria Caro-Crespo

Victoria (Assistant Stage Manager) is a high school junior, has been involved in St. Johns County Center for the Arts tech in many design and leadership positions. This is her first show with the Limelight Theatre. Recently, she worked as lightboard-op for SJCCA's *Every Christmas Story Ever Told and Then Some*, assistant stage manager for *Anastasia*, and stage manager for *The Dream on Royal Street*. She is very excited to work on this show!



## Day Stanchi

Day (Stage Manager) is a high school senior, and has been involved at the Limelight Theatre for seven years now. Most recently, she worked as a light & sound board-op for the Limelight KidzFACTory's *The Best Christmas Pageant Ever*, *The Musical*, *JV*; run crew for *Bright Star*; stage manager for *Into the Woods*; and stage manager for *Moon Over Buffalo*. This is her first time stage managing a mainstage show at Limelight, and she is very thankful and excited for the opportunity.



## Linda Takita

Linda (Costume Design) is the recipient of Hawaii State Theatre Council's Pierre Bowman Award for lifetime achievement in theatre in Hawaii. As Co-founder of Maui Academy of Performing Arts and its Executive Artistic Director, she created a drama education program for Maui's youth and wrote, produced, directed, or choreographed over 100 Academy productions including *The Sound of Music*, *Jesus Christ Superman*. Some of her favorite acting roles for the Academy and Maui Onstage are Mama Rose in *Gypsy*, Nellie Forbush in *South Pacific*, Annie Sullivan in *The Miracle Worker* and Regina Giddens in

*The Little Foxes*. As a director, favorites include *Once on This Island*, *Nunsense I and II*, *Rashoman* and *Jesus Christ Superstar*. Linda enjoys traveling with her husband Michael, gardening, reading, and scrapbooking photos of their 6 children, 11 grandchildren and 2 great-grandchildren. She was introduced to the Limelight by designing costumes for *Independence*.

**"GREAT THEATRE IS ABOUT CHALLENGING HOW  
WE THINK AND ENCOURAGING US TO  
FANTASIZE ABOUT A WORLD WE ASPIRE TO."**

**-WILLEM DAFOE**

*Thank you for supporting community theatre.  
Ned & Paula Skinner*

# Cast & Crew

## Michael Takita



Michael Takita (Light Design) was born on Maui. Michael lived in California before moving to France and recently to St. Augustine where he is happy to join the Limelight Theatre family. He's been involved with theatre since high school. He retired as Director of Information Technology for a large CPA firm in California. He's been Lighting Designer for numerous companies including Maui Onstage, Tihati Productions, Baldwin Theatre Guild and Maui Academy of Performing Arts which he co-founded 50 years ago. He had designed lights and sound at the Limelight for *Independence*, *First Date*, and the *Christmas Cabaret*. He enjoys fishing, playing with his dog, building things and spending time with family.

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